

# The Noble Forest-Dweller Clothed in Leaves Dhāraṇī

Ārya Parṇaśabarī Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 736 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་མ་ར་ཁི་ལོ་མ་གཞི་མ་ཞེ་བ་བྱའ་གཟུགས།

The Noble Forest-Dweller Clothed in Leaves, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Parṇaśabarī Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakma Ritrö Loma Gyönma Shyejawa'i Zung, is a dhāraṇī text dedicated to Parṇaśabarī, a fierce protective deity depicted as a short-statured, flesh-eating forest-dweller adorned with leaves and bearing a chopper and lasso. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre, comprising sacred ritual verses and invocations aimed at warding off epidemic diseases, death-bringers, and other dangers through the power of this goddess and her associated buddhas and bodhisattvas, including Amitābha and Avalokiteśvara. It is catalogued as Toh 736 in the Kangyur, where it is preserved among the dhāraṇī and protective spell literature of the Tibetan Buddhist canon.

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In the language of India: Ārya Parṇaśabarī Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Noble Forest-Dweller Clothed in Leaves."

Homage to the Noble Forest-Dweller Clothed in Leaves. Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Amitābha. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, lord endowed with great compassion. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being who has attained great power.

Homage to you, the Blessed One, the short-statured flesh-eating one, the Forest-Dweller Clothed in Leaves, holder of the chopper and the lasso.

Whatever fears may arise, all of them — whatever epidemic diseases may arise, whatever death-bringers may arise, whatever great death-bringers may arise, whatever harms may arise, whatever conflicts may arise, whatever inner injuries may arise — all of these arise only for the childish, not for the wise.

Go forth with truth, with words of truth, with speech of truth. Rise up. By these foundations of secret mantra consecrated by the wise, guard me and all sentient beings. Completely protect us. Completely hold us. Completely sustain us. Grant peace and well-being. Remove punishments. Remove weapons. Subdue poisons as long as mountains stand. Remove the harm of fire. Remove the harm of water. Cut off harmful cold. Bind the boundaries. Bind the ground.

Thus: Amṛte amṛte, amṛta udbhave, amṛta sambhave, āśvaste āśvastamge, māmara māmara, māsara māsara — grant peace. Pacify all illness. Pacify all untimely death. Pacify all harmful influences of planets and stars. Pacify all fang-poison.

Blessed One, Forest-Dweller Clothed in Leaves: Tunna tunna, vitunna vitunna, tuṇa tuṇa, tumule svāhā. Oṃ gaure, Gāndhārī, Caṇḍālī, Mātaṃgi, Pukkasi svāhā. Oṃ aṃkure, māṃkure, kurare, Paṇḍasābarī svāhā. Homage to all the forest-dwelling ones, to the great forest-dwelling ones, to the Blessed One who is a flesh-eating spirit, Paṇḍasābarī the flesh-eating spirit svāhā. Oṃ piśāci Paṇḍasābarī hrīḥ jaḥ hūṃ phaṭ piśāci svāhā.

The dhāraṇī of the Noble Forest-Dweller Clothed in Leaves is complete.

## Translator's Notes

- The deity Paṇḍasābarī is a tantric goddess of the forest-dwelling class, associated with protection from epidemics and plagues. She belongs to the piśāca class of flesh-eating spirits, which is explicitly affirmed in her epithets within this dhāraṇī. The term "Blessed One" applied to her uses the same honorific as for the Buddha, which is standard in tantric literature when addressing a fully empowered divine protectress.

The phrase rendered "as long as mountains stand" for the idiom around subduing poison to the limit of mountains preserves an idiomatic expression in the Tibetan that indicates duration or scope; it could alternatively mean "subdue mountain-range poisons entirely," but the sense of totality is preserved either way.

The names Gāndhārī, Caṇḍālī, Mātaṃgi, and Pukkasi within the mantra section are names of outcaste or tribal female figures who appear throughout tantric protective literature and are not translated, being proper names within the mantra body.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.